

V

Symbol for volume.

value

(i) When an expression is simplified, the result is the value of the expression.

Example

$$\frac{3+5}{2} \times 7$$
$$= \frac{8}{2} \times 7$$
$$= 4 \times 7$$
$$= 28$$

28 is the value of $\frac{3+5}{2} \times 7$

(ii) When solving equations, we evaluate them.

Example

Find the value of $\frac{x+5}{2}$, if $x = 10$.

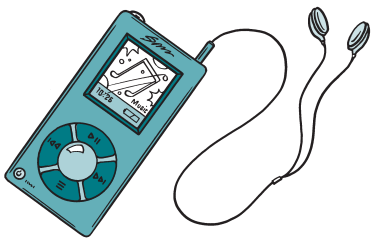
Answer: $\frac{10+5}{2} = 7.5$

7.5 is the value.

(iii) The amount of money something is worth.

Example





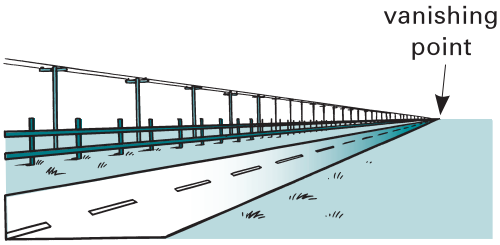
An MP3 player costs $78. Its value is $78.

See equation, evaluate, place value

vanishing point

In perspective, the point or points at which all parallel lines appear to meet.

Example



See perspective

variable

(i) A symbol or letter representing an unknown member of a set. In algebraic expressions, a variable stands for a value. Sometimes it is called an unknown.

Example

In $x^2 + 3x + 2 = 0$, x is the variable.

(ii) The same variable may have different values under different conditions.

Example

$x + 3 = 5$ $\quad x = 2$

$x - 1 = 10$ $\quad x = 11$

(iii) A mathematical sentence that has at least one variable is called an open number sentence.

Example

$x + 3 = 7$ is true only when $x = 4$.

The number 4 is called the solution of $x + 3 = 7$.

If x is replaced by any other number, the sentence will become not true (false).

See algebraic expression, constant, number sentence, open number sentence, place holder, pronumeral, symbol